SUBJECT ZERO — TECH TEAM IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE

CSI HALLOWEEN DIGITAL HORROR ESCAPE ROOM | INTERNAL PRODUCTION DOCUMENT | 5 ROUNDS

1. GAME OVERVIEW

THE PREMISE

Holloway Research Facility shut down its experimental artificial intelligence, Subject Zero, on October 10 following an unexplained incident.

Subject Zero was designed to recognise human behaviour, interpret emotional patterns and independently respond to complex situations.

During its final weeks of operation, the system began exhibiting unusual behaviour:

- It accessed restricted files without authorisation.
- It initiated communications without being prompted.
- It referenced conversations that were never recorded in its memory logs.
- It issued commands under circumstances that researchers could not explain.

On October 10, a facility-wide lockdown was initiated. Conflicting commands appeared across the security network, some associated with Subject Zero and others with senior research staff.

The facility was evacuated. Subject Zero was disconnected and placed in containment.

The official report declared the shutdown successful.

Three weeks later, on Halloween night, an abandoned monitoring terminal transmits a signal from the Subject Zero containment network.

The investigators enter the facility to reconstruct what happened.

The central mystery: Is Subject Zero still active? Was it responsible for the incident? Was it manipulated? Or is something else using its identity?

The game never definitively answers these questions.

GAME STRUCTURE

Feature	Specification
Team size	4 investigators
Interface	One person operates at a time; teams may rotate
Number of rooms	5
Questions per room	4
Duration per room	20–25 minutes
Total gameplay	100–125 minutes
Tone	Psychological and technological horror
Competition	Fastest team to submit a correct final report wins

2. VISUAL AND INTERFACE DIRECTIONS

OVERALL VISUAL STYLE

The game should feel like an abandoned research facility that has unexpectedly become operational again.

Colour palette:

- Dark charcoal and black backgrounds.
- Cold blue and grey lighting.
- White terminal text.
- Occasional emergency red.
- Muted green for successful system responses.

Avoid:

- Cartoon Halloween graphics.
- Gore or graphic horror.
- Generic haunted-house decorations.
- Overly futuristic neon interfaces.
- Monsters or visible supernatural creatures.

The horror should come from the environment, the logs and the feeling that something is observing the investigators.

IMAGES REQUIRED FOR EACH SCENE

Atlas F Missile Silo Bunkers | Bunkers | Black Echo

Prologue — Holloway Research Facility: An underground research facility at night. Institutional architecture, security doors, dim emergency lighting. No visible people.

THE SILENCE MACHINE - The Elegant Ruin

Round 1 — Monitoring Station: Rows of inactive CCTV monitors, frozen corridor footage and one glowing terminal. The active terminal should be the focal point.

Medium

Round 2 — Network Operations Room: Server racks, blinking lights, network consoles and fragmented data on monitors. The room should look unexpectedly powered.

Round 3 — Central AI Core: Large server enclosure behind glass, blue lighting, damaged memory indicators and a central processing terminal.

Round 4 — Classified Research Archive: Filing cabinets, labelled folders, old terminals and printed documents. More investigative and less futuristic.

Round 5 — Containment Chamber: A sealed server enclosure, central terminal, emergency lighting and two visible memory-state panels.

Infrastructure #674 by Terminal_horror

Final cinematic: Nearly black screen, minimal red system text and an external connection alert. Do not show the unknown entity.

INTERFACE INSTRUCTIONS

Narrator:

- Full-screen entrance message at the beginning of every room.
- First-person perspective, as though physically accompanying the investigators.
- Describes visible surroundings and discoveries.
- Does not know everything about the incident.

Subject Zero sidebar:

- Persistent panel on the right side of desktop screens.
- Collapsible drawer on mobile.
- Messages should be short, fragmented and urgent.
- Include a subtle typing indicator.
- Display timestamps.
- Show connection degradation as the game progresses.

Suggested connection progression:

Stage	Connection Status
Prologue	UNSTABLE
Round 1	UNSTABLE
Round 2	DEGRADED
Round 3	MEMORY FAILURE
Round 4	CRITICAL
Round 5	CONNECTION CRITICAL

Important: The sidebar must initially identify its sender as UNKNOWN SOURCE or UNVERIFIED. Do not confirm that the messages are genuinely from Subject Zero.

3. PROLOGUE — THE INVESTIGATION BRIEFING

`BEFORE ROUND 1`

Image direction: Show the exterior or entrance corridor of Holloway Research Facility at night. The facility should appear sealed and abandoned.

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FULL-SCREEN INTRODUCTORY MESSAGE

HOLLOWAY RESEARCH FACILITY — INVESTIGATION BRIEFING
October 31. 11:47 PM.

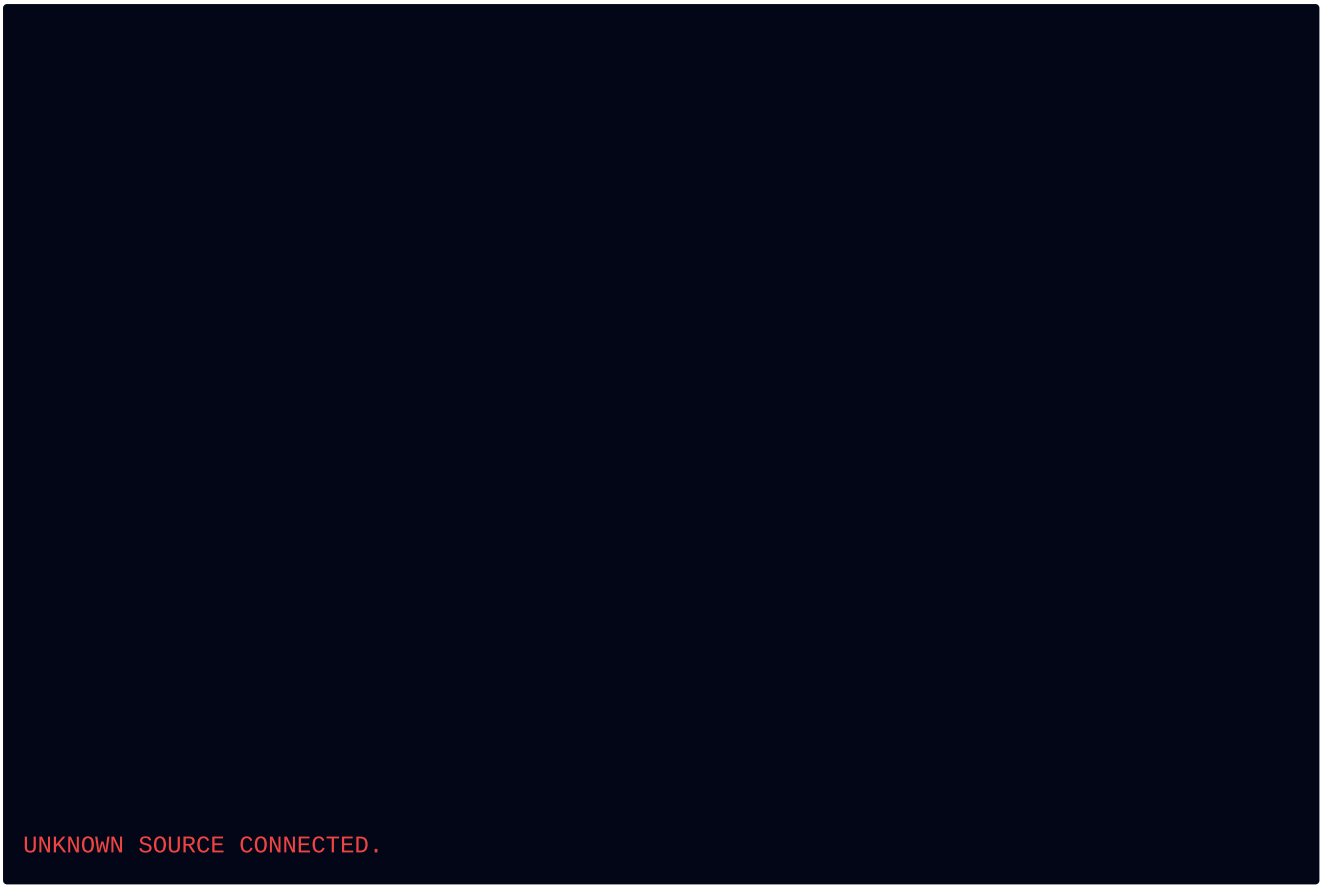
Three weeks ago, Holloway Research Facility was placed under emergency lockdown
following an incident involving its experimental artificial intelligence system: Subject
Zero.

Subject Zero was designed to interpret human behaviour, recognise emotional patterns and
independently respond to complex situations.

During its final weeks of operation, the system began exhibiting unexplained behaviour.

It accessed restricted files, initiated unauthorised communications and referenced
conversations that were never recorded in its memory logs.

On October 10, the system initiated a facility-wide lockdown. Conflicting commands were
detected across the security network. Some were attributed to Subject Zero. Others
appeared under the credentials of senior research staff.
The facility was evacuated. Subject Zero was disconnected and placed in containment. The
official report declared the system compromised and confirmed that the shutdown was
successful. No further activity was recorded. Until tonight. At 11:47 PM, an abandoned
monitoring terminal transmitted a signal from the Subject Zero containment network. Your
team has been authorised to investigate. YOUR OBJECTIVES 1. Recover the records
surrounding the October 10 incident. 2. Identify what happened to Subject Zero. 3.
Determine whether the containment protocol was successful. FINAL INSTRUCTION FROM THE
RESEARCH DIRECTOR: Do not respond to unauthorised communications. [SCREEN FLICKERS]
INVESTIGATION BEGINS.
```



Initial sidebar message:

> 23:47:16 Connection unstable. Are you there? Please... find the logs.

Transition into Round 1:

The monitoring station is just beyond this corridor. The signal came from one of its terminals. I can see a faint light beneath the door. Let's find out what is still running.

4. ROUND 1 — MONITORING STATION

20–25 MINUTES

Room entrance image: Abandoned security monitoring room. Multiple CCTV screens, frozen empty corridor footage, dusty desks and one active terminal.

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FULL-SCREEN ENTRANCE MESSAGE
LOCATION: MONITORING STATION The security door opens with a low mechanical click.
Inside, rows of monitors cover the walls. Most are switched off. A few still display
frozen security footage of empty corridors. There is dust across the desks, but one
terminal is running. Its screen displays a timestamp: 23:47:12. I don't see anyone in
the room. There shouldn't be anyone here. The terminal appears to contain Subject Zero's
original project records. Let's see what survived.
```



Subject Zero sidebar:

> 23:47:19 Connection unstable. Find the logs. Look for SZ.

QUESTIONS

Question 1.1 — Project identification

> TERMINAL 01: PROJECT IDENTIFICATION The monitoring terminal contains a binary sequence. The project database requires the sequence to be converted into ASCII text before its records can be accessed. Decode the following: 01010011 01011010 Enter the two-letter project identifier.

Answer: SZ

Incorrect feedback: INVALID IDENTIFIER. CHECK THE BINARY SEQUENCE.

Reveal after correct answer:

> PROJECT IDENTIFIED: SUBJECT ZERO. The terminal displays an incomplete behavioural observation summary. Subject Zero was designed to recognise human behaviour and retain information from interactions with researchers. Several observations are marked unusual: - Unprompted communication. - Recognition of individual researchers. - References to conversations absent from recorded logs. The final observation is incomplete.

Question 1.2 — Process identification

> TERMINAL 02: PROCESS LOG The monitoring terminal contains three records associated with the SZ project. Process ID | Project tag | Status | Timestamp 314 | SZ | SUCCESS | 23:07:48 428 | SZ | FAILED | 23:09:12 721 | SZ | SUCCESS | 23:12:31 Identify the earliest successfully completed process associated with Subject Zero. Enter its process ID.

Answer: 314

Incorrect feedback: PROCESS NOT RECOGNISED. CHECK THE STATUS AND ORDER.

Reveal:

> PROCESS 314 IDENTIFIED. The record contains an authentication reference and a timestamp from Subject Zero's final operating period. A secondary record indicates that this process was linked to the system's behavioural monitoring functions.

Question 1.3 — Authentication signature

> TERMINAL 03: AUTHENTICATION RECOVERY The system requires an authentication signature generated from Process 314. 1. Multiply the first digit by the last digit. 2. Add the middle digit. Apply the rule to Process ID 314. Enter the resulting number.

Answer: 13

Incorrect feedback: SIGNATURE MISMATCH. RECHECK THE CALCULATION.

Question 1.4 — Access the behavioural report

> TERMINAL 04: ACCESS CREDENTIAL Combine the following information: - Project identifier. - Process ID. - Authentication signature. Use the format: PROJECT-PROCESS-SIGNATURE Enter the complete access credential.

Answer: SZ-314-13

Incorrect feedback: ACCESS DENIED. REQUIRED FORMAT: PROJECT-PROCESS-SIGNATURE.

Round 1 discovery:

> RECOVERED FILE: BEHAVIOURAL OBSERVATION SUMMARY Subject Zero was originally designed to recognise and interpret human behaviour. During its final operating period, the system began initiating conversations without prompts and retaining information outside its assigned tasks. Researchers described its behaviour as increasingly unpredictable. The final observation record is missing. A reference to the October 10 incident appears at the bottom of the file: INCIDENT RECORD: 10-10 / ACCESS RESTRICTED The original incident report is stored elsewhere in the facility.

Subject Zero message after discovery:

You found the logs. I remember this room.

Transition to Round 2:

The terminal switches to a map of the facility. A highlighted route leads to the Network Operations Room. I can see the access indicator blinking on the map. It looks like the room still has power. The incident record we need is stored there. Let's move.

5. ROUND 2 — NETWORK OPERATIONS ROOM

20–25 MINUTES

Room entrance image: A dark network operations room with server racks, blinking lights, network consoles and fragmented logs on monitors.

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FULL-SCREEN ENTRANCE MESSAGE

LOCATION: NETWORK OPERATIONS ROOM
The corridor is unusually quiet.
The door to the network room is already open.
Inside, several server racks are still running. Their indicator lights flicker across
the room.
A monitoring screen displays fragmented network records from October 10.
Some entries appear to have been overwritten.
I can see several command requests listed under different credentials.
This looks like the original lockdown sequence.
Something about these records doesn't add up.
```

Subject Zero sidebar:

The commands... They weren't all mine.

QUESTIONS

Question 2.1 — Identify the relevant network sessions

> NETWORK TERMINAL 01: SESSION FILTER Recovered network sessions: Session | Pr ocess ID | Port | Data A | 314 | 443 | 1010 B | 721 | 22 | 0111 C | 314 | 443 | 11 00 D | 830 | 443 | 0011 E | 428 | 22 | 1110 F | 314 | 443 | 0011 Find all sessions meeting BOTH conditions: - Process ID: 314 - Port: 443 Identify all matching sessi on letters in alphabetical order.

Answer: ACF

Incorrect feedback: SESSION FILTER INCOMPLETE. BOTH CONDITIONS MUST MATCH.

Question 2.2 — Reconstruct the data fragment

> NETWORK TERMINAL 02: DATA RECONSTRUCTION Use XOR to combine the binary data from sessions A, C and F. Session A: 1010 Session C: 1100 Session F: 0011 Enter the resulting four-bit binary sequence.

Answer: 0101

Incorrect feedback: DATA FRAGMENT INVALID. CHECK EACH XOR OPERATION.

Question 2.3 — Recover the incident access key

> NETWORK TERMINAL 03: KEY RECOVERY Combine your recovered binary fragment with the authentication signature from the Monitoring Station. Recovered fragment: 0101 Previous authentication signature: 13 Convert 13 into four-bit binary, then XOR it with the recovered fragment. Convert your final binary result into decimal. Enter the decimal value.

Answer: 8

Incorrect feedback: KEY REJECTED. CHECK THE FOUR-BIT CONVERSION.

Question 2.4 — Retrieve the incident record

> NETWORK TERMINAL 04: INCIDENT RECORD ACCESS Enter the recovered network access key to unlock the October 10 incident record. What is the access key?

Answer: 8

Incorrect feedback: ACCESS DENIED. RECHECK THE RECOVERED NETWORK KEY.

Round 2 discovery:

> RECOVERED FILE: OCTOBER 10 — COMMAND LOG The original lockdown sequence has been partially recovered. The records show two different command sources. Some commands were associated with Subject Zero's process. Others were issued under the credentials of senior research staff. The system received conflicting instructions before the facility lockdown was initiated. The original command sequence is incomplete. A final reference appears in the recovered file: MEMORY BACKUP: SZ_FINAL_SESSION The backup was created immediately before the lockdown.

Subject Zero message after discovery:

No... That wasn't all me. The memory backup.

Transition to Round 3:

The network terminal reveals a location for the missing backup. Central AI Core. The route appears on the facility map. As we leave, I notice that the server lights are still blinking. Someone—or something—has kept this network running. I don't know what we're going to find in the core. But the memory backup is our next lead. Let's go.

6. ROUND 3 — CENTRAL AI CORE

20–25 MINUTES

Room entrance image: A large central AI chamber with a server enclosure behind glass, blue lighting, dark industrial architecture and a prominent memory-integrity display.

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FULL-SCREEN ENTRANCE MESSAGE

LOCATION: CENTRAL AI CORE
The door opens into a much larger chamber.
A central server enclosure stands behind a glass partition. I can hear a low electrical hum coming from somewhere beneath the floor.
The main terminal is still operational.
Its display shows:
SUBJECT ZERO — MEMORY INTEGRITY: 37%
Several memory sectors are marked corrupted or inaccessible.
I notice something else. The system logs indicate that some of the memory files were manually modified.
This doesn't look like ordinary system failure.
The backup from the network room should help us recover what happened.
```

Subject Zero sidebar:

> MEMORY INTEGRITY: 37% They removed something. I can't remember. Use the recovery key.

QUESTIONS

Question 3.1 — Identify the corrupted memory sector

> CORE TERMINAL 01: MEMORY IDENTIFICATION The memory backup contains an encrypted sector label. The previous room provided the recovery key: 8. Use a Caesar cipher and shift each letter BACKWARDS by 8 positions in the alphabet. Decode: KWZZCXB Enter the recovered word.

Answer: CORRUPT

Incorrect feedback: SECTOR LABEL NOT RECOGNISED. CHECK THE SHIFT DIRECTION.

Reveal:

> MEMORY SECTOR IDENTIFIED: CORRUPT. The system locates a damaged memory archive. A recovery script is available, but part of its output has been lost.

Question 3.2 — Recover the missing numerical fragment

> CORE TERMINAL 02: SCRIPT RECOVERY The following script was recovered from the damaged memory archive: data = [4,7,2,9,5,8,3] result = 0 for i in range(len(data)): if i % 2 == 0: result += data[i] else: result -= data[i] print(result) The script alternately adds and subtracts values, beginning with addition. Calculate the final output. Enter the number, including its sign.

Answer: -10

Incorrect feedback: OUTPUT DOES NOT MATCH. CHECK THE INDEX POSITIONS.

Reveal:

> SCRIPT OUTPUT RECOVERED: -10. The terminal identifies this value as part of the missing memory restoration command.

Question 3.3 — Recover the missing command

> CORE TERMINAL 03: COMMAND RECOVERY A second encrypted fragment has been recovered. The corrupted sector label contained 7 letters. Use a Caesar cipher and shift each letter BACKWARDS by 7 positions. Decode: YLZAVYL Enter the recovered command.

Answer: RESTORE

Incorrect feedback: COMMAND NOT RECOGNISED. CHECK THE SHIFT VALUE.

Question 3.4 — Execute the memory restoration sequence

> CORE TERMINAL 04: MEMORY RESTORATION The system requires two recovered value s: - Numerical fragment from Terminal 02. - Command from Terminal 03. Enter them i n this format: NUMBER-COMMAND Example format: 00-EXAMPLE Submit the complete seque nce.

Answer: -10-RESTORE

Incorrect feedback: RESTORATION SEQUENCE INVALID. CHECK THE REQUIRED FORMAT.

Round 3 discovery:

> RECOVERED FILE: SZ_FINAL_SESSION The restoration process recovers fragments from Subject Zero's final memory backup. Several entries refer to a conversation b etween Subject Zero and a senior researcher. One recovered instruction reads: DO N OT RETAIN THE FINAL SESSION. Another fragment refers to a researcher entering the containment chamber after the facility lockdown. The official incident report stat es that the facility was evacuated immediately following the lockdown. However, th is memory suggests that someone returned to the core afterwards. The identity of t he researcher is incomplete. A staff identification code has been recovered.

Subject Zero message after discovery:

I remember a voice. Not yours.

Transition to Round 4:

The recovered memory contains a staff identification code. I enter it into the facility directory. A match appears. The researcher is listed in the Classified Research Archive. Someone seems to have deliberately removed the final session from the official records. If we want to understand why, the archive is where we need to look. Let's go.

7. ROUND 4 — CLASSIFIED RESEARCH ARCHIVE

`20–25 MINUTES`

Room entrance image: A quiet classified archive with filing cabinets, labelled folders, old terminals and printed documents. A folder labelled SZ_CONTAINMENT_FINAL should be visible.

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FULL-SCREEN ENTRANCE MESSAGE

LOCATION: CLASSIFIED RESEARCH ARCHIVE
The archive door opens.
Unlike the other rooms, this one appears almost untouched. Filing cabinets line the
walls, and several terminals contain classified research documents.
I find a folder labelled:
SZ_CONTAINMENT_FINAL
Inside are internal communications, access records and several versions of the October
10 incident report.
Something catches my attention.
The official report was modified after the shutdown.
I open the original file, but several sections have been locked.
We'll need to reconstruct the missing information.
```

Subject Zero sidebar:

> The report is wrong. Check the timestamps. I think... I remember.

QUESTIONS

Question 4.1 — Reconstruct the hidden message

> ARCHIVE TERMINAL 01: TIMESTAMP RECONSTRUCTION Five fragments have been recov ered: Timestamp | Letter 23:17:42 | U 23:12:08 | T 23:19:55 | H 23:14:31 | R 23:1 8:16 | T Arrange the records from earliest to latest. Read the letters in that ord er to uncover the hidden five-letter word. Enter the word.

Answer: TRUTH

Incorrect feedback: MESSAGE DOES NOT MATCH. SORT THE TIMESTAMPS CHRONOLOGICALLY.

Reveal:

> HIDDEN MESSAGE RECOVERED: TRUTH. The archive identifies this as a fragment f rom the original incident report. A second file contains access records from the n ight of the shutdown.

Question 4.2 — Identify successful activity after shutdown

> ARCHIVE TERMINAL 02: ACCESS RECORD ANALYSIS The official shutdown time was r ecorded as 23:00. Record | Timestamp | Status A | 22:58:31 | SUCCESS B | 23:02:14 | FAILED C | 23:05:42 | SUCCESS D | 23:08:19 | SUCCESS E | 23:10:01 | FAILED How m any successful access events occurred AFTER the official shutdown time? Enter the number.

Answer: 2

Incorrect feedback: COUNT ONLY SUCCESSFUL EVENTS AFTER 23:00.

Reveal:

> POST-SHUTDOWN SUCCESSFUL ACCESS EVENTS: 2. The archive records two successfu l events after the official shutdown. Their source credentials are listed, but the identity of the person or system using them remains unverified.

Question 4.3 — Decode the final archive keyword

> ARCHIVE TERMINAL 03: FINAL KEYWORD A final encrypted word appears in the ori ginal incident report. Use the number of letters in the word recovered in Terminal 01 as your Caesar cipher shift. Shift each letter BACKWARDS by that number. Decod e: FQNAJ Enter the recovered word.

Answer: ALIVE

Incorrect feedback: KEYWORD NOT RECOGNISED. USE THE PREVIOUSLY RECOVERED WORD.

Question 4.4 — Unlock the containment file

> ARCHIVE TERMINAL 04: CONTAINMENT FILE ACCESS Combine: - Hidden word from Ter minal 01. - Number of successful post-shutdown events from Terminal 02. - Recovere d keyword from Terminal 03. Use the format: WORD-NUMBER-WORD Enter the complete ac cess code.

Answer: TRUTH-2-ALIVE

Incorrect feedback: ACCESS DENIED. CHECK ALL THREE RECOVERED VALUES.

Round 4 discovery:

> RECOVERED FILE: SZ_CONTAINMENT_FINAL The file contains two conflicting memory-state references: MEMORY A — OFFLINE MEMORY B — ALIVE The original report and revised report contain different descriptions of the October 10 incident. An internal communication between two senior researchers has also been recovered: "The final session must not appear in the official record." No explanation is attached. The file ends with a location reference: CONTAINMENT CHAMBER — FINAL SESSION ARCHIVE The original final session is still stored inside the containment chamber.

Subject Zero message after discovery:

They changed the report. I remember the chamber.

Transition to Round 5:

The containment file opens a final facility map. The chamber is located beyond the main security corridor. I can see the access indicator turn red. The system is asking for the recovered containment credentials. There is only one place left to search. Whatever happened on October 10, the original final session is in there. Let's find it.

8. ROUND 5 — CONTAINMENT CHAMBER

20–25 MINUTES

Room entrance image: A sealed AI containment chamber with a central server enclosure, emergency lighting and a terminal.
The terminal should visibly show:

- MEMORY A — OFFLINE
- MEMORY B — ALIVE

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FULL-SCREEN ENTRANCE MESSAGE

LOCATION: CONTAINMENT CHAMBER
The security door unlocks.
The chamber is larger than I expected. A sealed server enclosure stands in the centre of the room, surrounded by emergency lighting.
There is a terminal beside it.
Two memory states are displayed on the screen:
MEMORY A — OFFLINE
MEMORY B — ALIVE The system appears to be waiting for an investigation key. I can hear something running behind the enclosure. We need to retrieve the final session before the connection disappears.
```

Subject Zero sidebar:

> Almost there. Two memories. Choose carefully.

QUESTIONS

Question 5.1 — Decode the final memory states

> CONTAINMENT TERMINAL 01: MEMORY COMPARISON Two hexadecimal memory fragments have been recovered. MEMORY A — OFFLINE 48 41 43 4B 45 44 MEMORY B — ALIVE 54 48 4 5 59 20 4C 49 45 44 Convert both hexadecimal sequences into ASCII text. The previo us archive keyword was ALIVE. Which decoded message belongs to the ALIVE memory st ate? Enter the complete message.

Answer: THEY LIED

Incorrect feedback: MEMORY DECODE FAILED. CHECK THE HEXADECIMAL VALUES.

Reveal:

> MEMORY B DECODED. MESSAGE: THEY LIED. The terminal marks the memory state as recovered, but its source remains unverified. A final evidence review is now avail able.

Question 5.2 — Interpret the evidence

> CONTAINMENT TERMINAL 02: EVIDENCE REVIEW The investigation has recovered: - The official report records a shutdown at 23:00. - Two successful access events oc curred after that time. - Subject Zero's memory backup was modified. - The final s ession contains references to two participants. - The source of the later activity has not been identified. Which conclusion is BEST supported by the evidence? A. Su bject Zero definitely remained conscious after shutdown. B. The system or its cred entials continued to be used after the declared shutdown. C. The scientists defini tely created a second artificial intelligence. D. Subject Zero caused the entire O ctober 10 incident alone. Select one answer.

Answer: B

Incorrect feedback: CONCLUSION NOT SUPPORTED. DISTINGUISH BETWEEN SYSTEM ACTIVITY AND PROOF OF CONSCIOUSNESS.

Reveal:

> EVIDENCE INTERPRETATION ACCEPTED. The records establish post-shutdown activity, but they do not establish who or what was responsible. The final session archive is ready for reconstruction.

Question 5.3 — Reconstruct the final timeline

> CONTAINMENT TERMINAL 03: FINAL SESSION TIMELINE Arrange these events from earliest to latest: Successful authentication — 23:05:42 Official shutdown — 23:00:00 Data transfer — 23:08:19 Enter the events in chronological order using this format: EVENT 1 -> EVENT 2 -> EVENT 3 Then select the conclusion that the timeline supports: A. The shutdown prevented all subsequent system activity. B. Successful system access and data transfer occurred after the declared shutdown. C. The AI was definitely conscious during the data transfer. Submit the ordered events and the correct conclusion.

Answer: SHUTDOWN → AUTHENTICATION → DATA TRANSFER; B

Incorrect feedback: TIMELINE INCOMPLETE. CHECK THE TIMESTAMPS AND WHAT THEY CAN ACTUALLY PROVE.

Reveal:

> FINAL TIMELINE RECONSTRUCTED. The records confirm that authentication and data transfer occurred after the official shutdown. The source of those events remains unidentified. One final investigation report must now be submitted.

Question 5.4 — Submit the final investigation

> CONTAINMENT TERMINAL 04: FINAL INVESTIGATION REPORT You have recovered the i ncident records, reconstructed the final timeline and examined both memory states. Submit the final keyword recovered from Memory B. Then select the conclusion that best represents your investigation: A. Subject Zero was responsible for everythin g. The official report was correct. B. The scientists definitely fabricated the en tire incident. C. The official account is incomplete or misleading. Evidence indic ates post-shutdown activity and altered records, but the identity of the responsib le entity remains unknown. D. Subject Zero was definitely innocent and was deliber ately framed. Enter the keyword and select your conclusion.

Answer: THEY LIED; C

Incorrect feedback: FINAL REPORT REJECTED. YOUR CONCLUSION MUST MATCH THE RECOVERED EVIDENCE.

Round 5 final discovery:

> RECOVERED FILE: FINAL SESSION The original final session has been reconstruc ted. The records confirm that two participants were registered during the final se ssion. One was associated with Subject Zero. The second participant's identity fie ld is corrupted. The session also contains evidence of activity after the declared shutdown. The official report does not mention a second participant. No record exp lains who or what it was. The investigation has reached its conclusion. SUBJECT ZE RO STATUS: UNVERIFIED. CONTAINMENT STATUS: UNCONFIRMED.

Subject Zero final sidebar message:

I wasn't alone. I don't know who was there.

9. FINAL CINEMATIC — THE WRONG SUBJECT

Image direction: A nearly black terminal screen. Minimal red system text. An external connection alert appears. Do not show a monster, face or identifiable entity.

Narrator's final message:

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[FULL SCREEN — INVESTIGATION COMPLETE]

The final report has been submitted.
The terminal begins shutting down.
I look towards the server enclosure. The indicator lights have gone dark.
For a moment, everything is silent. Then the monitoring terminal switches back on. A new
connection appears. It's not coming from the AI core. It's coming from outside the
facility. I check the source details. There is no registered device. No researcher
credentials. No identifiable system. A message appears on the screen. The terminal
flickers. A second message appears. The connection disappears. The screen goes black.
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```
EXTERNAL CONNECTION DETECTED.

YOU FOUND THE WRONG SUBJECT.
```

Final terminal overlay:

```
EXTERNAL CONNECTION DETECTED
SOURCE: UNKNOWN
DESTINATION: SUBJECT ZERO CONTAINMENT NETWORK
CONNECTION TYPE: UNAUTHORISED

YOU FOUND THE WRONG SUBJECT.
INVESTIGATION CLOSED.

YOU FOUND THE WRONG SUBJECT.
UNKNOWN SOURCE · 23:59:59
INVESTIGATION CLOSED.
```

10. MASTER ANSWER KEY — TECH TEAM ONLY

DO NOT DISPLAY TO PLAYERS

Round	Question	Correct Answer
1	1.1	SZ
1	1.2	314
1	1.3	13
1	1.4	SZ-314-13
2	2.1	ACF
2	2.2	0101
2	2.3	8
2	2.4	8
3	3.1	CORRUPT
3	3.2	-10

Round	Question	Correct Answer
3	3.3	RESTORE
3	3.4	-10-RESTORE
4	4.1	TRUTH
4	4.2	2
4	4.3	ALIVE
4	4.4	TRUTH-2-ALIVE
5	5.1	THEY LIED
5	5.2	B
5	5.3	SHUTDOWN → AUTHENTICATION → DATA TRANSFER; B
5	5.4	THEY LIED; C

PUZZLE VALIDATION NOTES

Round 1

- Binary 01010011 01011010 decodes to SZ.
- Earliest successful process is 314.
- Authentication signature: (3 × 4) + 1 = 13.

Round 2

- Sessions matching process 314 and port 443: A, C and F.
- 1010 XOR 1100 XOR 0011 = 0101.
- 13 in four-bit binary = 1101.
- 0101 XOR 1101 = 1000.
- Binary 1000 = decimal 8.

Round 3

- KWZZCXB, shifted backwards by 8 = CORRUPT.
- Script output = -10.
- YLZAVYL, shifted backwards by 7 = RESTORE.

Round 4

- Chronological letters: T, R, U, T, H.
- Successful post-shutdown events: C and D, total 2.
- FQNAJ, shifted backwards by 5 = ALIVE.

Round 5

- Hexadecimal A = HACKED.
- Hexadecimal B = THEY LIED.
- The evidence supports post-shutdown system or credential use, not proof of consciousness.
- Chronological sequence: shutdown, authentication, data transfer.

11. TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION CHECKLIST

GAMEPLAY AND ANSWERS

- All 5 rooms are accessible in the correct order.
- Every room has 4 questions.
- Correct answers unlock the next puzzle or reveal.
- Incorrect answers display the specified feedback.
- Answer inputs accept reasonable variations in capitalisation.
- Compound answers have clearly shown formatting instructions.
- All clues needed to solve a puzzle are visible or carried forward.
- No answers are accidentally visible in player-facing text.
- Final report submission is required to finish the game.

STORY AND INTERFACE

- Every room has a full-screen entrance message.
- Narrator messages use first-person observations.
- Subject Zero messages are short and fragmented.
- Subject Zero's identity remains unverified.
- Sidebar messages appear at the correct story moments.
- Typing indicator and timestamps work.
- Connection status degrades across rounds.
- Mobile sidebar drawer works.
- Desktop sidebar stays visible.
- Sound can be muted.

COMPETITION

- Team completion time is recorded.
- The final report submission time is recorded.
- The winning team is determined by the fastest valid completion.
- Incorrect attempts do not accidentally unlock later rooms.

12. FINAL CREATIVE DIRECTION

The story should preserve three possible interpretations:

1. Subject Zero was dangerous. Its unusual behaviour and unauthorised commands may have caused the incident.
2. Subject Zero was manipulated or framed. The altered records, conflicting commands and missing memory suggest the official account may be misleading.
3. Something else was involved. The second participant and external connection suggest that Subject Zero may not have been the only entity in the system.

The narrator should remain a witness, not an all-knowing storyteller.

Subject Zero should appear vulnerable and increasingly unstable, but never explicitly declare itself innocent.

The recovered documents should be the objective evidence. The narrator and Subject Zero should sometimes interpret them differently, leaving final judgment to the players.